

Unit 4 teacher notes

Before you teach: obtain the primary document

This unit references Pakistan's *National Professional Standards for Teachers* (2009) throughout and does not reproduce it, following the course's citation policy. **Obtain a copy before Week 9.**

Topic 4.2's practicum task and the indicator-writing activity both assume trainees can read at least one standard in full. If you cannot supply copies, the unit still teaches the architecture, but the activities become hypothetical and lose most of their value.

The unit's own source record notes a verification limitation worth passing on: the document was not retrievable from the authoring environment, and the names of the ten standards used in Topic 4.2 were corroborated from secondary sources rather than read from the primary text. **Check them against your copy.** If any differ, that is a correction to make in the unit, not an error to teach around.

Sequencing across the three-week block

Four topics over three weeks: 4.1 in Week 9, 4.2 in Week 10, and 4.3 with 4.4 in Week 11.

Give 4.1 a full week even though it is conceptually the lightest. The four uses of a standard are the analytical tool the rest of the unit runs on, and a cohort that has not internalised them reads 4.4 as an opinion about bureaucracy rather than as a design argument.

Topics 4.3 and 4.4 belong together in the same week. Read separately, 4.3 sounds like an exhortation to be honest and 4.4 like a complaint about administration. Read together, they are one argument: honest self-evaluation is

professionally valuable, and it only survives if the system is built so that honesty is not punished.

The misconceptions that recur

"Standards and a code of conduct are the same thing." Near-universal, because both are official documents about teachers. The Topic 4.1 comparison table exists for this. Press on the question each answers rather than on what each contains, since the contents do overlap.

"A standard tells you how to teach." Correct this early or trainees will read the NPST as a prescribed method and resent it. The space a standard deliberately leaves is where Unit 3's professional judgement operates.

"Meeting the indicators is the goal." The most consequential of the four, because acting on it produces exactly the behaviour the framework was built to prevent. The indicator-gaming activity in Topic 4.2 is the intervention; do not shorten it.

"Appraisal and professional development are the same process." Trainees have usually only met systems where they are combined. Ask how many have ever told an appraiser something they were bad at. The answer in the room makes the argument better than the text does.

The activity that most often goes wrong

The Topic 4.2 indicator-writing activity depends on pairs genuinely trying to defeat each other's indicators. Groups that are polite to one another produce indicators nobody attacked, and the lesson does not land.

Set it up as adversarial and explicitly reward the pair that finds the cleverest way to satisfy an indicator without the competence. Trainees are often reluctant, because it feels like teaching dishonesty. Name that objection directly: you are teaching them to anticipate how a measure will be gamed, which is exactly what whoever designs their appraisal should have done and frequently has not.

Practical work

Read one standard in full (Week 10). The Topic 4.2 practicum task. The reliable finding is that the dispositions part is nearly impossible to evidence by observation, which sets up Topic 4.3's material on evidence types. Collect a show of hands on that question rather than the written work; it is faster and the pattern is what matters.

One full self-evaluation cycle (Week 11). The Topic 4.3 task. Three lessons will usually be too few for the re-collection stage to show change, and trainees should report that as a finding rather than manufacture a result. Say so in advance, or you will receive five reports of successful improvement in a fortnight.

Ask one question in the debrief and give it time: **were you tempted to improve the record rather than the practice?** An honest cohort will say yes. That admission is the unit's most important learning moment and does not survive being rushed.

Appraisal enquiry (Week 11). The Topic 4.4 task asks what really happens in the school's appraisal. Prepare for the common finding of a process that is formally summative and decides nothing. The unit does not cover that case, and it is worth ten minutes of discussion: an appraisal with no consequence is not neutral, because it teaches that the standards are decoration.

Marking the unit assessment

The bank is on the unit assessment page with model answers and analytic rubrics.

ERQ 2 is the integrative item and the best single indicator of whether the unit landed, because it requires the three-part internal division to be applied to specific described behaviours rather than recited.

The rubrics cap a response that does not reach "Adequate" on the analysis, evaluation or creation criterion at 10 out of 20. In this unit the characteristic strong-looking weak answer is a fluent summary of what standards are for that never applies them to anything.

Tip: select any text on this page first to comment on that specific passage - or leave nothing selected for general feedback.

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